

Steven Boada, Ph.D

Basic Information	(615) 200-0119 stevenboada@gmail.com	github.com/boada linkedin.com/in/theboada
Professional Experience	Activision Publishing, Inc. <i>Lead Data Scientist, Gameplay</i> As part of the game science team, I lead a data science team that ships ML and analytics systems into Call of Duty titles. I combine deep ML engineering background with hands-on people leadership, experimentation strategy, and cross-functional partnerships. Specifically, I: • Define and lead high-impact analytics initiatives with design leadership, analyzing how gameplay systems (maps, modes, weapons, communication systems, etc.) influence player behavior and top-line KPIs, and translating insights into actionable design recommendations. • Own experimentation strategy for gameplay features, guiding the design and evaluation of A/B tests, statistical models, and large-scale player behavior analyses. • Champion gameplay measurement strategy and data quality, partnering with engineering to improve telemetry coverage, instrumentation, and analytical reliability. • Elevate team analytical capability by mentoring data scientists, reviewing experimental designs and analyses, and promoting best practices in experimentation, statistics, and data storytelling. <i>Senior Data Scientist, Gameplay</i> Restarted advanced gameplay analytics support for partner studios and live Call of Duty titles. Highlighted Project: Led study design and analysis of input advantage across controller and mouse/keyboard players, directly resulting in a rework of the aim assist system shipped in Black Ops 7 (2025). <i>Senior Machine Learning Engineer</i> Provided technical direction and leadership to junior data scientists end-to-end — designing, developing, and deploying recommendation systems integrated into Modern Warfare 2 (2022) and Modern Warfare 3 (2023). Designed and maintained ML infrastructure including autoML, CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), model tracking (MLflow), and orchestration (Airflow). Crafted and implemented policy for external data ingestion and retention to ensure accessibility and proper data stewardship across the organization. Developed near-realtime applications (via Spark streaming) to identify and mitigate in-game cheating and malicious behaviors, achieving action times in the low 10s of seconds. Spearheaded the transition of ML infrastructure from AWS to GCP/GCS, optimizing scalability and performance. Built customer conversion, churn prediction, and behavioral segmentation models using survival analysis, clustering, and tree-based methods. <i>Insight Data Science Fellow</i> Completed a data science bootcamp focused on transitioning academics into the tech industry, working on real-world data problems. Built a random forest model in Python to prioritize NYC restaurant inspections, improving violation detection by 2.5% and identifying critical issues up to 7 days earlier through an AWS-deployed API.	Boulder, Colorado March, 2026 – Present January, 2024 – 2026 January, 2021 – 2024 New York, New York January, 2020 – 2021
Skills	Machine Learning: Linear Models, Decision Trees, SVM, Clustering, Deep Learning, Survival Analysis Engineering & MLOps: Open Source Contributor, Python, Spark, SQL, MLflow, Airflow, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, AWS, GCP, Databricks Leadership: Team management, mentorship, experimental design review, cross-functional stakeholder communication, workshop facilitation, Eagle Scout AI & Agentic Systems: LLM integration (Claude, GPT), prompt engineering, agentic workflow design, multi-agent orchestration, AI coding tools (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot)	
Education		

Texas A&M University, College Station, Texas

- Ph.D, Physics (astronomy focus), 2016

The University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Tennessee

- M.S., Physics (astronomy focus), 2009
- B.S., Physics, 2007